

Understand the open-game starting point

Opening Decisions

THE IDEA

After 1.e4 e5, both sides have space and access to developing squares. The struggle often concerns the central tension and rapid piece activity. Learn typical pressure on e4, e5, f2, and f7 before studying long variations.

WORKED EXAMPLE

The sequence 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 develops knights and contests e5. White can then choose bishop development or a central challenge. Each choice shapes which pieces can enter quickly and how the center may open.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What is Black doing with 2...Nc6 besides developing?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Defending the e5 pawn and influencing d4. The knight also occupies c6, which affects future use of the c-pawn. Even natural moves have both benefits and constraints.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Read opening moves as bundles of concrete functions.